Group Information:

Project Title: Gameboxd

Names:

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GitHub: https://github.com/NAMalt/WPFinalProject.git

Project Description:

Our application is for users to share reviews and ratings of video games they have played. People who have played lots of video games and want to share what they have played and their opinions on games, or perhaps people who want to get into video games are the target audience.

Background and Motivation:

We are all familiar with Letterboxd/ IMBD for rating movies, in addition to this, we all play videogames and figured that something similar might be an interesting challenge. There are apps that exist for logging video games, but they don't have as much work put into them as something like Letterboxd. They also aren't mobile-friendly so we figured we would try to make our own version with the potential of having a mobile equivalent although this is something to be discussed in the optional features.

Wireframes and Prototyping:

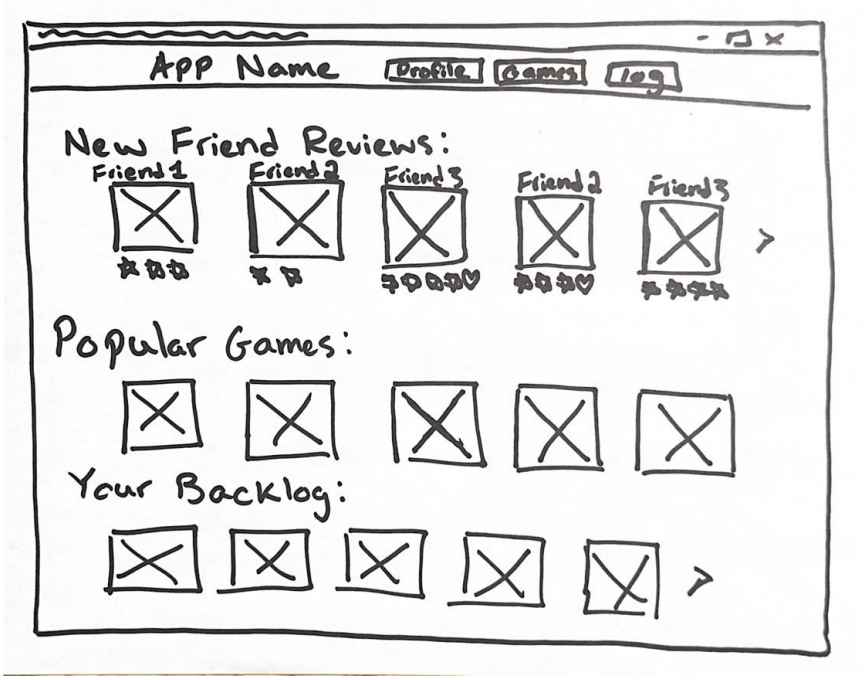

Figure 1: Home Page

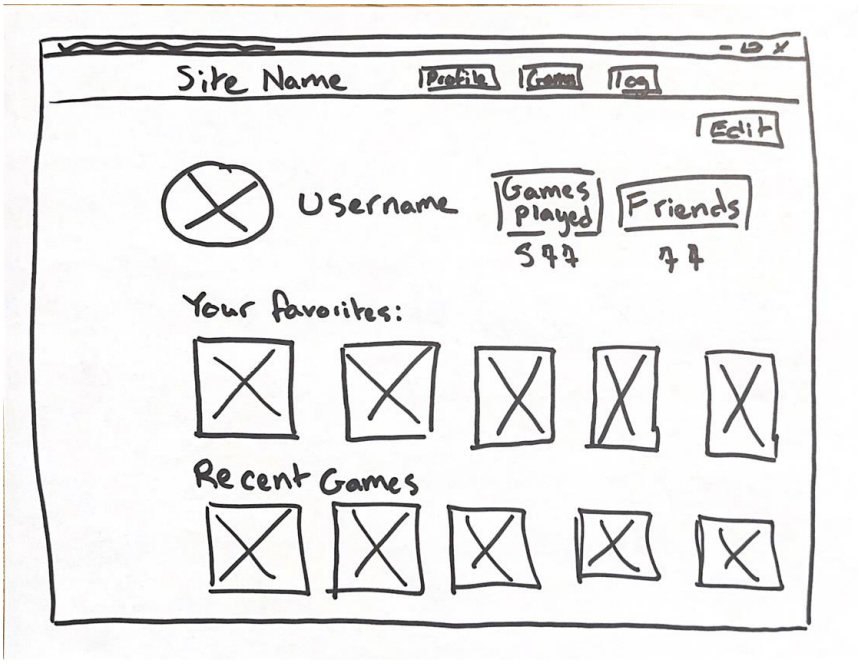

Figure 2: Profile Page

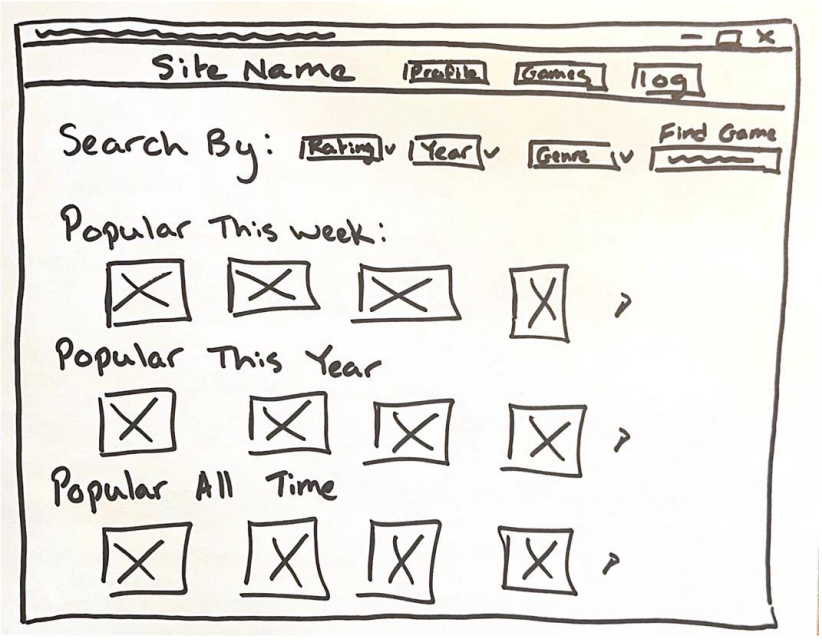

Figure 3: Games Search Page

Figure 4: Log Game Page

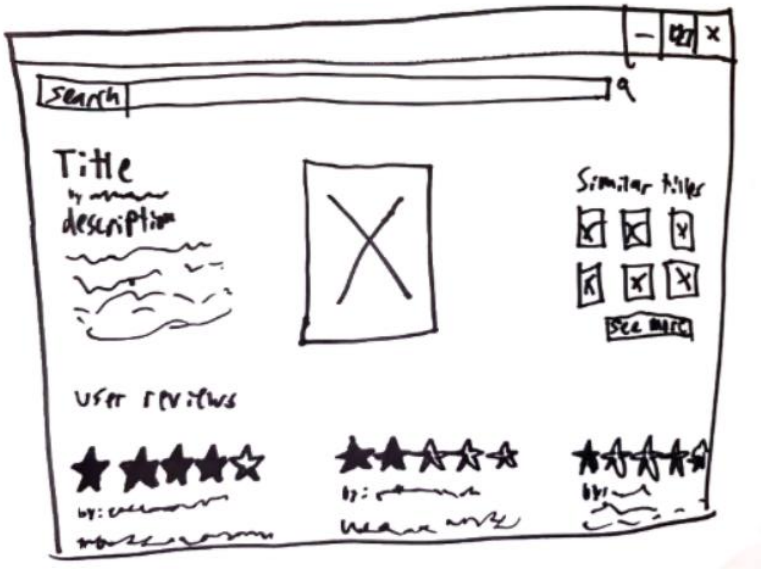

Figure 5: Game Details

Description of Wireframes/Prototypes:

Figure 1 shows the "Home" page which is the page that loads after the user signs in. At the top is a banner which allows the user to navigate to the other parts of the site which are: their profile, a games search page, and the log games page. Below that are three rows, one that shows recent friend reviews, one that shows the current top five games, and that last one that shows the users backlog (the list of games they have saved that they want to play).

Figure 2 is the "Profile" page. The banner is still present at the top so that users can click on where they want to go. In the top right under the banner is an edit button so that users can change their profile and their top five favorite games. Below the edit button in "row 0" is the users profile image, the number of games played (which can be clicked to display a list of their games played), and their friends (which can be clicked to show their friends list). In row 1 is a list of the users top 5 games which can be manually selected in the edit profile page. In row 2 is a list of the 5 most recent games the user has played.

Figure 3 is the "Games" page which allows users to search for any game in the database. At the top, once again, is the banner which allows users to navigate the page. Underneath that are 3 drop down menus corresponding to various filters that will change the contents of the page, in addition to a search-bar that will allow users to search for a specific title. The default layout if the user has not searched anything shows 3 list of popular games; by week, by year, and by all time.

Figure 4 is the “Log” page, which is for when a user wants to log a game. On the left side of the page is the title of the game, along with the cover art image. Below this is the release date, developer, and genre information. On the right side is the text box for users to write their review which has a scroll bar in case the review is longer than the text box, to the left of this is a heart button for users to “like” the game (almost like an upvote or if platers really enjoyed the game). Directly below this is the star rating system for users to give the game a score. Below the users own review they can read their friend’s reviews on the game, in addition to other users’ reviews.

Figure 5 is the “Game Details” page where users can view the game's information such as title, developer, release date, and description. This will also display the cover image of the game. This page also displays user reviews at the bottom, showing the rating, account name of the review, and the description of each review. On the right side, there is a section for Similar Titles, where it will show a few games that share similar tags and genres. Users can click See More below and will be directed to a page with more related titles. The search bar is still on the top if the user wants to search for another game directly from this page.

Must-Have Features:

To get everything that we want out of our program, there honestly is not as many features to implement into it as you may think. For starters, we would need to implement:

1. A user system, which entails a login page and an account creation page in case they are a new user. Once an account is created, users will be brought back to the login page.
2. With these ‘accounts’ we will then need to add a friends feature so that friends can share/compare reviews with each other. A friend would be tracked by a simple tag on an account if that makes sense. These accounts will also have the feature to select a profile picture from some non-copyright images.
3. After the login portions are taken care of, they would be taken to the main page. This main page will have features such as: ‘log a game’ ‘see games played’, and also show various lists of games that the algorithm recommends or what friends have been playing. This will be determined by the “genre” tag for each game. If a user enjoys games of a certain genre, then other games of the same genre will appear.
4. There would also be a directory to a profile page, which would show all of the games you played and reviews you have written.
5. When on the games page, users will have the feature to sort the games in any order from a drop down. This can sort by upload date, rating, and game genre.

6. As for the main topic, which is the page you write the actual game review, there will be a few features on it. There will be as follows:
   - The title of the game
   - A description of the game
   - A like button with a like counter
   - A textbox to actually write your review
   - A 5 star selector for an additional rating
   - A submit button to upload your review to the site
   - A scrollable section to read other reviews

Optional Features:

1. Video Game cover art appears on the website under the main menu, review page, profile etc. It would be difficult to find a single database with every video game cover art since there are tons of video games (because of a much bigger market compared to movies and Letterboxd doesn't even have every movie). Copyright also becomes an issue here, if we are able to find an API that handles that for us then it would be much easier to implement.
2. Mobile compatibility, the app should be easily viewable and usable on a mobile web browser. This is a problem that is too common in websites like this that already exist. There generally seems to be too much friction since the site was designed for desktop. Letterboxd solves this by making a separate mobile experience while still maintaining core features.
3. A database of our games. Right now, we have a Json file with a list of ~20 handpicked games that are stored locally. If we can get the database to work then it would allow for a wider selection of games.

Project Schedule:

Feb 20: Proposal Due/ GitHub setup

Feb 21 – Mar 6: All four core pages: Log, Games, Profile, Home completed/ connected in html + CSS (Nick)

Mar 7 – Mar 27: Log in/ Sign up page html/CSS (Nick) + Accounts (Michael + Justin)

Mar 28- Apr 10 Profile pictures (Justin), games sorting feature on the games page (Michael + Justin), backlog (Nick)

Apr 11- Apr 24: Cover Art integration (Michael + Justin), Polish up UI (Nick), Any optional Features (All)

Apr 25 – May 1: Testing, Bug fixes, Deployment, Video Review (All)

Questions To Answer: (Everything below is new and answers the highlight changes in Blue above)

1. How do you plan to implement the "top 5 games" feature on the "Home" page? (e.g., will this be from an existing dataset? what will you do if you aren't able to find a data with game ranking information?)

Top 5 games will be from our user ratings so no outside database. The star rating gets converted to a number i.e 2.5 stars = 50/100, 5 stars = 100/100, 4.5 = 90/100. Then you just average this number and the highest rated game goes first.

2. How will the layout of the "Profile" page change when the "Number of games" button is clicked to "display a list of their games played"? Will you need another page for this information?

It will open a new html page, with “back to profile button”. Users will no longer have access to the nav bar, similar to the login/create account page.

3. How will you implement the functionality for users to edit their "top 5 games"? Will there a dropdown that users can select from directly on the "edit profile" page? Will editing a favorite game temporarily take them to a separate page with a full list of games that they can select from?

On the edit profile page, there will be an option to change the games, when a slot is clicked it will open up the list of “games played” which users can select from. Users will only be able to log games they have played.

4. How will the layout of the "Games" page change if a user filters by a year that isn't the current year? (top games this week, this year, and all time will no longer be relevant categories).

Those filters would then be hidden if the user selects those options.

5. In your must-have features section, is the "rate a game" feature a link to the "log game" page?

No, these were referring to the same page. We just hadn’t decided on a final name to call it at the time of submission so that is just a typo.

6. In your must-have features section, is the "see games played" feature a link to the "profile" page?

No, for the same reason as the question above. We just hadn't decided on a name for that page yet, it is now called "Profile".